Current System Architecture Analysis

Factual specification of Trading Strategy Lab as implemented in this repository. This document is the input for architecture and runtime-flow diagrams.

Source of truth: `frontend/src`, `backend/app`, Alembic revisions under `backend/alembic` and `backend/alembic_live`, `backend/pyproject.toml`, `frontend/package.json`, and `.env.example`.

Not used as source of truth: `vendor/TradingAgents` (reference only; nothing under `backend/app` imports it). `.env` is gitignored and was not read. No secrets are included.

Not queried: no live database was opened. Schema claims are in CURRENT_DATABASE_ARCHITECTURE.md.

Analysis date: 2026-10-10.

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1. Current system components

1. Frontend

Field	Value
Name	Next.js UI
Responsibility	Dashboard (index quotes, paper positions and orders), markets (candle charts, manual paper orders), lab (ingest, clarify, review, trades), deploy (policy, backtest, approval), deployments (start, pause, stop, flatten, equity, odds, floor)
Technology	Next.js 15.5.27, React 19.1.0, Tailwind CSS 4, `lightweight-charts` 5
Main files	`frontend/src/app/layout.tsx`, `frontend/src/app/page.tsx`, `frontend/src/app/markets/page.tsx`, `frontend/src/app/lab/page.tsx`, `frontend/src/app/deploy/page.tsx`, `frontend/src/app/deployments/page.tsx`, `frontend/src/lib/api.ts`, `frontend/src/lib/market.ts`, `frontend/src/lib/policy.ts`, `frontend/src/components/*`
Sync/async	Browser `fetch`
Invoked by	User browser
Invokes	FastAPI at `NEXT_PUBLIC_API_URL` (default `http://127.0.0.1:8841`)
External deps	None. Market data reaches the browser through FastAPI
Storage	`localStorage` keys `tsl.actor` and `tsl.token` only

Routes: `/`, `/markets`, `/lab`, `/deploy`, `/deployments`. There is no login page. A Bearer token is optional until the API requires one.

2. Backend API

Field	Value
Name	FastAPI application
Responsibility	HTTP API for ingest, review, journal, audit, live trading, market quotes, and manual paper orders

Field	Value
Technology	FastAPI, Uvicorn, Pydantic v2
Main files	`backend/app/main.py`, `backend/app/api/routes.py`, `backend/app/api/journal.py`, `backend/app/api/audit.py`, `backend/app/api/live.py`, `backend/app/api/market.py`, `backend/app/api/common.py`
Sync/async	Synchronous route handlers. Review and approval backtests run inside the request
Invoked by	The UI and operators (`GET /api/health`)
Invokes	Stores and crews listed below
Database	Request-scoped SQLAlchemy sessions for the research database and, on `/api/live`, the live database

Middleware order in `backend/app/main.py` (Starlette runs the last-added middleware first, so CORS is the outer wrapper):

1. `CORSMiddleware` — origins from `CORS_ORIGINS`. `*` is refused at startup when `API_TOKENS` is non-empty.

2. `AuditContextMiddleware` — accepts or generates `X-Request-ID` and reads `X-Actor`.

There is no rate limit, idempotency key, or HTTPS redirect middleware.

3. Ingest and extract

Field	Value
Name	Strategy ingest
Responsibility	Fetch source text and extract a strategy Markdown document
Technology	`youtube-transcript-api`, `httpx`, BeautifulSoup with the `lxml` parser, LangChain chat models
Main files	`backend/app/ingest/youtube.py`, `instagram.py`, `doc.py`, `store.py`, `backend/app/extract/extractor.py`, `backend/app/strategies/clarify.py`
Invoked by	`POST /api/ingest/extract`, `POST /api/ingest/clarify`, and `POST /api/demo/run`
External deps	YouTube, Instagram, or the document URL when those source types are used. OpenAI or Anthropic when `LLM_PROVIDER`'s key is set
Database	`ingest_runs`, then `strategies` and `strategy_versions`

`document` URLs that return a PDF are rejected. The demo fixture is `backend/fixtures/notebooklm_notes.txt`.

4. Review Crew

Field	Value
Name	Review Crew
Responsibility	Audit, scenario simulation, hard-stop sweep, per-trade reviews, verdict, improvement proposals
Technology	LangGraph `StateGraph`
Main files	`backend/app/agents/review_crew/graph.py`, `reviewer.py`, `hard_stop.py`, `improver.py`, `backend/app/engine/sim.py`, `backend/app/engine/costs.py`
Invoked by	`POST /api/review/run` and the demo path
Database	`reports`, `simulation_runs`, `sim_trades`, `trade_reviews`, `strategy_improvements`

Node order: `audit` → `scenarios` → `simulate` → `hard_stop` → `trade_review` → `verdict` → `improve`.

5. Trade Crew

Field	Value
Name	Trade Crew
Responsibility	One deployment's decision loop. Rules in code decide. The LLM cannot open or close a trade
Technology	LangGraph `StateGraph`, run as its own process
Main files	`backend/app/agents/trade_crew/graph.py`, `runner.py`, `__main__.py`, `opinion.py`, `lessons.py`, `legs.py`
Invoked by	`python -m app.agents.trade_crew` or the supervisor
Database	Live tables only, plus read-only use of the market database

Node order, stopping early when a node sets `stop`: `verify` → `gate` → `hours` → `observe` → `reconcile` → `exits` → `drawdown` → `daily` → `entry` → `risk` → `opinion` → `explain` → `execute`.

6. Live control plane

Field	Value
Name	Approvals, supervisor, kill switch
Responsibility	Freeze a strategy version, start and stop deployments, restart crashed crews, flatten
Main files	`backend/app/live/approvals.py`, `gates.py`, `supervisor.py`, `kill_switch.py`, `store.py`, `equity.py`, `drawdown.py`, `money.py`, `odds.py`, `policy_backtest.py`, `veto.py`, `opinion_eval.py`
Invoked by	`/api/live/*` and `python -m app.live`
Database	Live database. Approval also writes `strategy.approved_for_live` on the research audit log

7. Brokers

Field	Value
Name	Broker registry
Responsibility	Resolve an account to an adapter
Main files	`backend/app/brokers/registry.py`, `base.py`, `paper.py`, `sandbox.py`, `credentials.py`, `backend/app/trading/orders.py`
Registered adapters	`paper` (no quotes, replay feed only), `sandbox` (quotes; `live` mode only when `SANDBOX_ALLOW_LIVE=true`)
Not registered	Zerodha, Upstox, Dhan, Angel One, or any other exchange broker

8. Market data

Field	Value
Name	Market reference store
Responsibility	NSE end-of-day bars, option closes, events, headlines

Field	Value
Main files	`backend/app/market/models.py`, `store.py`, `nse.py`, `feed.py`, `calendar.py`, `news.py`, `hours.py`, `historical.py`, `source.py`
Writers	`backend/scripts/import_nse_eod.py`, `import_events.py`, `fetch_news.py`
Database	`MARKET_DATABASE_URL` (default `sqlite:///data/market_eod.db`). Not audited. Created with `create_all`, not Alembic

9. Markets and manual paper orders

Field	Value
Name	Market screen backend
Responsibility	Delayed quotes and candles for indices, NSE stocks, and global commodity futures. Manual paper orders with Indian charges, and positions netted from those orders
Main files	`backend/app/api/market.py`, `backend/app/paper.py`
Invoked by	`/`, `/markets`
External deps	Yahoo Finance's unofficial chart API over `httpx`. Delayed, no MCX data, can change without notice
Database	`paper_orders` in the research database (append-only). Quotes and candles are not stored

Paper orders are separate from the Trade Crew and from `orders` in the live database. Commodities are view-only. Stocks trade as shares (`EQ`) only. Index orders are `FUT`, `CE`, or `PE` and need a lot size from `LOT_SIZES`. Charges use the cost profile with slippage 0; futures and delivery equity use fixed FY2025-26 rates in `backend/app/paper.py`. Positions mark shares and futures at the latest quote, with index spot as the futures proxy. Options are not marked.

10. LLM

Field	Value
Name	Chat model factory
Responsibility	Build the OpenAI or Anthropic chat client selected by `LLM_PROVIDER`
Main files	`backend/app/llm.py`
Call sites	Extractor, improvement rationale, trade opinion, post-trade lesson, optional `--explain` note
Not a call site	Order placement, exits, and risk checks

`LLM_TRADE_OPINION` is `off`, `shadow`, or `veto`. Veto is also enabled per deployment and can only skip or reduce lots. Live accounts stay refused unless `LLM_VETO_LIVE_ALLOWED=true`.

11. Auth

Field	Value
Name	Static API tokens
Responsibility	Optional Bearer auth. The token name becomes the audit actor
Main files	`backend/app/auth/__init__.py`, `backend/app/auth/__main__.py`, `backend/app/api/common.py`

Field	Value
Storage of tokens	SHA-256 hashes in `API_TOKENS`. The token itself is printed once by `python -m app.auth new-token`
When `API_TOKENS` is empty	Research and paper mutating routes accept `X-Actor`. Credential routes, live account creation, live approval, live start, live veto, live capital events, and `stop` with `flatten` still return 403

There is no user table and no OAuth login.

12. Alerts

Field	Value
Name	Alert dispatcher
Main file	`backend/app/alerts.py`
Channels	Telegram (`httpx`) and SMTP (`smtplib`). Either channel is skipped when its settings are empty
Failure behaviour	Logged. Delivery failure does not block trading

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2. Frontend architecture

The root layout in `frontend/src/app/layout.tsx` renders five links: Dashboard (`/`), Markets (`/markets`), Strategy Lab (`/lab`), Deploy (`/deploy`), Deployments (`/deployments`).

`frontend/src/lib/api.ts` sends `Authorization: Bearer` when `tsl.token` is set, and `X-Actor` when `tsl.actor` is set. HTTP 401 and 403 become `AuthError`.

Page	What it calls
`/`	Index quotes, paper positions and orders. An exit link opens `/markets` with the closing order pre-filled
`/markets`	Quotes, candles with previous-day and pivot levels (`CandleChart`), paper order placement, positions and orders
`/lab`	Ingest, clarifying questions and re-extract, demo, review run, strategy and report reads, trade list
`/deploy`	Broker list and accounts, credential save, approval preview, rules-only versus policy backtest, approval. Form covers sizing, compounding, booking, time and event exits, daily target, VIX sizing, withdrawal, odds gate, drawdown ladder, and capital floor
`/deployments`	List, start, pause, stop, stop-and-flatten, equity, positions, capital events, drawdown, money (floor and withdrawal), odds

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3. API architecture

Routers are mounted with no extra prefix beyond the one on each router.

Router	Prefix	File
Lab	`/api`	`backend/app/api/routes.py`

Router	Prefix	File
Journal	`/api`	`backend/app/api/journal.py`
Research audit	`/api/audit`	`backend/app/api/audit.py`
Live	`/api/live`	`backend/app/api/live.py`
Market and paper	`/api`	`backend/app/api/market.py`

Lab and journal routes include `GET /api/health`, `POST /api/ingest/extract`, `POST /api/ingest/clarify`, `GET /api/ingest-runs/{id}`, `POST /api/review/run`, `POST /api/demo/run`, strategy and report reads, `POST /api/strategies/{id}/archive`, trade CSV, `GET /api/journal`, trade reviews, and improvement decisions.

Live routes include brokers, broker accounts, credentials, approval preview, approval backtest, approval, deployment start/pause/stop, capital events, llm-veto, equity, positions, orders, live trades, opinions, phantom trades, and the live audit chain. The live read routes return 503 until `alembic -n live upgrade head` has been applied.

Market and paper routes are `GET /api/market/quotes` (up to 40 symbols), `GET /api/market/candles` (`1m`, `5m`, `15m`, `60m`, `1d`), `POST /api/paper/orders`, `GET /api/paper/orders`, and `GET /api/paper/positions`. Quotes and candles return 400 for an unknown symbol, and candles return 502 when Yahoo is unreachable.

OpenAPI is the FastAPI default at `/docs`. There is no separate contract file.

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4. Ingest pipeline

1. `POST /api/ingest/extract` receives `source_type` plus a URL or text.

2. YouTube and Instagram fetchers, or the HTML fetcher, produce text. `markdown` and `notebooklm` use the supplied text.

3. `extract_strategy` calls the chat model when a key is configured. Otherwise the demo path can use the fixture extractor.

4. `IngestRunStore` inserts `ingest_runs` (extractor, model, raw output, status).

5. A successful extract parses Markdown into a `StrategyDocument` and inserts `strategies` plus `strategy_versions`.

6. The response, and `GET /api/strategies/{id}`, include `questions` from `clarifying_questions`. Required questions cover a missing underlying, structure, entry, stop, target, max lots, or a rule error. Optional ones cover event blackouts, a VIX range, daily entry and loss limits, and each Gap.

7. `POST /api/ingest/clarify` turns the author's answers into hints, appends them to the original run's hints, re-extracts from the stored source, and saves a new strategy version. It returns 400 when the version was not ingested from a source, when no LLM key is set, or when no answer was given.

The extractor emits a `rules:` block and does not invent thresholds. Unexpressed rules go into Gaps.

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5. Review pipeline

1. `POST /api/review/run` loads a strategy version or raw Markdown.

2. `run_review_crew` invokes the compiled graph.

3. `simulate` uses `open_market_source`. Imported NSE data is preferred. The bundled sample is the fallback and is recorded as `data_source`.

4. The report row stores `inputs` from `backend/app/provenance.py` and the JSON payload, including `hard_stop_sweep`.

5. Simulation runs and `sim_trades` are inserted. Reviews and improvements are inserted in the same research transaction path as the report store.

The hard-stop sweep does not change `verdict_label`.

`verdict_label` is one of `Not executable`, `Profitable` (every scenario passes net checks), `Conditional` (some pass), `Too few trades` (none pass and every scenario is below `VERDICT_MIN_BACKTEST_TRADES` or `VERDICT_MIN_FORWARD_TRADES`), or `Not profitable`. The verdict also counts scenarios that lose money before costs and scenarios with too few trades, and the narrative names both.

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6. Market data and simulation

Backtests walk the strategy's rules once per session on end-of-day closes. Positions carry across days. Expired legs settle at intrinsic value. Charges use the cost profile and, when the trade date is known, `STT_SCHEDULE` and `EXCHANGE_TXN_SCHEDULE`.

IV rank uses history only up to the decision day (`IV_RANK_LOOKBACK_DAYS`, minimum history `IV_RANK_MIN_HISTORY`).

Entry blackouts read `market_events`. If a blackout rule is set and no calendar is imported, entries are blocked.

News headlines are stored with `published_at` and `fetched_at`. Callers that build LLM context keep headlines published at or before the decision time.

The Trade Crew broker feed builds quotes from the adapter, with previous-day high and low and VIX history from this database. Lot size and freeze quantity prefer the broker instrument list.

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7. LLM architecture

`chat_model` in `backend/app/llm.py` constructs `ChatAnthropic` or `ChatOpenAI` from `LLM_PROVIDER`. Temperature is `0`. The unused provider is not constructed.

Use	Can change an order
Strategy extraction	No. It writes Markdown that a person can edit
Improvement rationale	No. It appends text to a proposal
`LLM_TRADE_OPINION=shadow`	No. The opinion is stored
`LLM_TRADE_OPINION=veto` after per-deployment enablement	Skip or fewer lots only, and only on an entry the rules already approved
`TRADE_CREW_EXPLAIN` or `--explain`	No. A note is appended to `reason_text` after the decision

There is no embedding model and no vector store.

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8. Evaluation

Mechanism	Where it is stored	What it decides
Scenario verdict	`reports.verdict_label`	Whether the fixed scenarios passed net checks. Not the `rules:` replay
Hard-stop sweep	`reports.payload`	A recommended capital stop, also proposed as an improvement
Deterministic trade review	`trade_reviews`	Process verdict and mistake tags. `rules_version` is `REVIEW_RULES_VERSION`
Human review	`trade_reviews` or `live_trade_reviews`	A later row may set `supersedes_review_id`
Opinion evaluation	Computed by `GET /api/live/opinions/evaluation`	No verdict until `OPINION_EVAL_MIN_SAMPLES` skip or reduce opinions have closed
Rules backtest at approval	Not stored as a report row; returned by the backtest endpoint	Rules only versus rules plus policy and ladder

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9. Authentication and authorization

`API_TOKENS` is a comma-separated list of `name:sha256(token)`. A valid Bearer token sets the actor and ignores `X-Actor`. An invalid token is 401.

`X-Actor` is not authenticated. The backend README states that the API should sit behind auth before it is exposed.

Credential ciphertext uses Fernet (`cryptography`) and `BROKER_CREDENTIALS_KEY`. API responses and audit details store a fingerprint, not the secret.

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10. Data and storage architecture

Three SQLite files by default, all relative to `backend/` when the URL is `sqlite:///data/...`. Any of the audited databases can be PostgreSQL (`postgresql+psycopg://...`). The driver is not in `backend/pyproject.toml`; Postgres needs `psycopg` installed separately.

Database	Setting	Migrations	Audit
Research	`DATABASE_URL`	`backend/alembic`, head `0006_paper_orders`	Hash-chained `audit_events`
Live	`LIVE_DATABASE_URL`	`backend/alembic_live`, head `0005_broker_credentials`	Hash-chained `live_audit_events`
Market	`MARKET_DATABASE_URL`	None (`create_all`)	None. Reports store a fingerprint of imported inputs

`strategies` can be updated and cannot be deleted. Every other research and live table is append-only in the ORM and in database triggers. The market tables can be updated; importers are written to be re-run.

Sandbox state files live under `SANDBOX_STATE_DIR` (default `DATA_DIR/sandbox`). Crew logs go to `DATA_DIR/logs/crew-<deployment>.log`.

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11. Observability

Signal	Implementation
Research audit chain	`audit_events.hash = sha256(prev_hash + canonical JSON)`
Live audit chain	`live_audit_events`, same construction
Request id	`X-Request-ID` echoed by `AuditContextMiddleware`
Crew liveness	`crew_heartbeats`. `crew_running` is false when the latest heartbeat is older than `HEARTBEAT_MAX_AGE_S`
Alerts	`backend/app/alerts.py`
Langfuse	Named in `.env.example` only. No import and no client in `backend/app`

Logging is the standard library. There is no metrics endpoint and no trace exporter.

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12. Deployment architecture

The API process does not tick the Trade Crew. Operators run either one `python -m app.agents.trade_crew` per deployment or `python -m app.live supervise`.

The supervisor starts one subprocess per `started` deployment, restarts crashes with backoff from 5 seconds to 5 minutes, and does not restart a crew that exits because a replay feed ran out. It also resumes a deployment paused by its capital floor when `resume_after_days` has elapsed.

Process templates: `backend/deploy/com.genesis.supervisor.plist` (launchd) and `backend/deploy/genesis-supervisor.service` (systemd). There is no Dockerfile and no compose file in this repository.

Local ports used by the root README: API 8841, UI 8842. `npm run dev` with no port uses Next.js's default of 3000, which does not match `CORS_ORIGINS` in `.env.example`.

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13. Present, absent, and reference-only

Item	Status	Evidence
Review Crew	Present	`backend/app/agents/review_crew/graph.py`
Trade Crew	Present	`backend/app/agents/trade_crew/graph.py`
Paper broker	Present	`backend/app/brokers/paper.py`
Manual paper orders	Present	`backend/app/api/market.py`, `backend/app/paper.py`
Real-time or MCX market data	Absent	Quotes come from Yahoo, delayed. Commodities are global futures in USD
Sandbox broker	Present	`backend/app/brokers/sandbox.py`
Exchange broker adapter	Absent	`registry.py` registers only `paper` and `sandbox`
TradingAgents package at runtime	Absent	No import from `vendor/` under `backend/app`

Item	Status	Evidence
Langfuse	Absent	Settings keys exist only in `.env.example`
Vector database, embeddings, RAG	Absent	No embedding client and no vector column
User accounts	Absent	No `users` table. Actors are strings
PDF ingest	Absent	`fetch_document_text` raises on PDF content types

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14. Current end-to-end flows

Lab

Browser → `POST /api/ingest/extract` or `POST /api/demo/run` → ingest row and strategy version → optional `POST /api/ingest/clarify` → new ingest row and strategy version → `POST /api/review/run` → Review Crew → report, simulations, trades, reviews, improvements → `GET /api/journal`.

Approve and paper-trade

Browser → `POST /api/live/approvals/backtest` (optional) → `POST /api/live/approvals` → `deployed_strategies` and `deployments` in the live database, plus a research audit event → `POST /api/live/deployments/{id}/start` → supervisor or a manual crew process → ticks → intents, orders, fills, live trades, heartbeats.

Manual paper trade

Browser on `/markets` → `GET /api/market/candles` → FastAPI → Yahoo → `POST /api/paper/orders` → `paper_orders` row with charges, plus a `paper.order_placed` audit event → `GET /api/paper/positions` → positions netted from orders and marked at the latest quote.

Kill switch

`POST /api/live/deployments/{id}/stop` writes the stop first, then cancels working orders. Protective stops stay unless `flatten` is true. Flatten requires a token, closes open positions, and then cancels the remaining stops.

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15. Architecture connection matrix

From	To	How
Browser	FastAPI	HTTP JSON
FastAPI	Research database	SQLAlchemy session `get_db`
FastAPI live routes	Live database	`get_live_db`
Review Crew	Market database	`open_market_source`
Trade Crew	Live database	`LiveStore`
Trade Crew	Market database	Previous range, VIX history, holidays
Trade Crew	Broker adapter	`BrokerAdapter` / `QuoteSource` from the registry

From	To	How
Supervisor	Trade Crew	Subprocess
FastAPI market routes	Yahoo Finance	HTTPS via `httpx`, per request, not cached
Alerts	Telegram or SMTP	HTTP or SMTP, only when configured
LLM factory	OpenAI or Anthropic	HTTPS via LangChain clients

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16. Diagram input

```
flowchart LR
  UI[Next.js UI]
  API[FastAPI]
  RC[Review Crew]
  TC[Trade Crew]
  SUP[Supervisor]
  RES[(Research DB)]
  LIVE[(Live DB)]
  MKT[(Market DB)]
  BR[Paper or Sandbox]
  LLM[OpenAI or Anthropic]
  YF[Yahoo Finance]

  UI --> API
  API --> RES
  API --> LIVE
  API --> YF
  API --> RC
  RC --> RES
  RC --> MKT
  RC --> LLM
  SUP --> TC
  TC --> LIVE
  TC --> MKT
  TC --> BR
  TC --> LLM
```

```
flowchart TD
  start([Tick]) --> verify
  verify --> gate
  gate --> hours
  hours --> observe
  observe --> reconcile
  reconcile --> exits
  exits --> drawdown
  drawdown --> daily
  daily --> entry
  entry --> risk
  risk --> opinion
```

```
  opinion --> explain
  explain --> execute
  execute --> done([End])
```

Any node from `verify` through `entry` can stop the tick before the later nodes run. `risk` always continues into `opinion`, `explain`, and `execute`.

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17. Evidence index

Claim	File
App wiring and CORS refusal	`backend/app/main.py`
Review graph nodes	`backend/app/agents/review_crew/graph.py`
Trade graph nodes	`backend/app/agents/trade_crew/graph.py`
Broker names	`backend/app/brokers/registry.py`
Settings	`backend/app/config.py`, `.env.example`
Research head revision	`backend/alembic/versions/0006_paper_orders.py`
Market and paper routes	`backend/app/api/market.py`, `backend/app/paper.py`
Clarifying questions	`backend/app/strategies/clarify.py`
Live head revision	`backend/alembic_live/versions/0005_broker_credentials.py`
Market `create_all`	`backend/app/market/store.py`
UI routes	`frontend/src/app/layout.tsx`
Token and actor storage	`frontend/src/lib/api.ts`

Configuration precedence

Pydantic defaults in `Settings` apply when a variable is unset. A copied `.env.example` overrides several of those defaults:

Variable	`Settings` default	`.env.example`
`DEFAULT_CAPITAL_INR`	500000	50000
`DEFAULT_MAX_LOTS`	2	1
`PORTFOLIO_MAX_OPEN_POSITIONS`	3	2
`PORTFOLIO_MAX_DAILY_LOSS_INR`	10000	3000
`MAX_ENTRIES_PER_DAY`	0	1
`MAX_CONSECUTIVE_LOSSES`	0	3
`LOSS_COOLDOWN_DAYS`	0	3
`MAX_LOSS_PCT_OF_CAPITAL`	0	100

`MAX_CONSECUTIVE_LOSSES` and `LOSS_COOLDOWN_DAYS` must both be set or both be 0. Strategy frontmatter overrides cost and size defaults. Common risk keys from the environment still apply, and the stricter of the environment value and the strategy value wins.

`LANGFUSE_SECRET_KEY`, `LANGFUSE_PUBLIC_KEY`, and `LANGFUSE_BASE_URL` are in `.env.example` and are not read by `Settings`.